



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Saint Constantine School of Houston

School Website: <https://saintconstantine.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

The Saint Constantine School (Houston, TX 77036) presents a robust Classical Christian program with explicit emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and beauty, integrated with Orthodox Christian formation. Public materials consistently frame education as formation of character and intellect within a liturgical, communal, and great-books-driven framework. The Upper School foregrounds Socratic dialogue and mastery of Great Books, while Lower/Middle School incorporate contemplative and memory-focused elements (Schol  -like rhythms, singing, and chant). The school also foregrounds liturgical practices (Divine Liturgy, morning prayers) and a strong sense of Church life, which strongly anchors its religious metaphysical foundations.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Key drivers of this classification include:

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are clearly centered in Orthodox Christian formation, liturgical practice, and sacred aims (truth, beauty, virtue in a theologically oriented framework) as reflected in mission statements and liturgical life. Evidence: emphasis on Eastern Orthodox alignment and liturgical prayer, divine liturgy, and mission statements tying education to salvation and God's glory.
- Purpose and Goal emphasize formation, virtue, and wisdom, with a stated aim of formational education alongside preparation for college. The core values explicitly name Wisdom, Virtue, and Joy; the mission ties education to piety and service, while still acknowledging college readiness via dual credit programs.
- Curriculum centers on the liberal arts, Great Books, and a Trivium/Quadrivium framework; explicit mention of Great Books and a block-schedule approach to integrate classics across disciplines. Latin/Greek and Christian-liturgical content are part of the program.
- Pedagogy includes both contemplative/restful elements and Socratic/seminar-based discussion, with upper-level rhetoric and public speaking opportunities, and lower-level memory/chanting practices. This aligns with the classical pedagogy spectrum.
- Faculty is presented as a central asset (facilitating a living curriculum and mentorship; examples of faculty pages and a robust full-time faculty), with a family/house system that reinforces the community.
- Parents & Community are positioned as partners (house system, parent involvement, and campus life designed to engage families and encourage visits).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents itself as classical, Christian education in harmony with the Eastern Orthodox Church, explicitly tying formation to God and salvation. - Liturgical and communal practices are integrated (Divine Liturgy, morning prayers), signaling the sacred dimension of education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; liturgy; morning prayers; Divine Liturgy; Orthodox Church; sacred/church-related terms. These terms appear across home/about pages and liturgical references. - Negative keywords present: none evident in public materials (no explicit secular, nonsectarian, or interfaith signals in the public-facing statements). Classical-leaning

materials emphasize theology, liturgy, and church alignment rather than secular neutrality. See the absence of terms like secular/nonsectarian in the public-facing text.

Why this rating - The school grounds its identity in a theologically-informed framework, with explicit Orthodox-affiliated formation and liturgical practice. The public-facing materials foreground sacred aims (salvation, God's glory) and communal worship, which strongly aligns with the Classical School's Religious and Meta-physical Foundations.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission and core values foreground formation and virtue: "Education in pursuit of virtue, wisdom, and joy"; core values include Wisdom, Virtue, and Joy. The mission emphasizes formation of character within a theistic framework. - Text frames education as formation, not only information. The school states it aims to form servant-leaders through classical, Christian education, for salvation and the common good. - There is explicit acknowledgment of truth, goodness, beauty, and a telos toward human excellence; Great Books and a classical mission appear in admissions and curriculum narratives.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, scholé (where applicable in classical lexicon), love of learning, virtuous life. The site repeatedly highlights formation and virtue as central aims. - Negative keywords present: some public materials emphasize college readiness and dual-credit pathways; the Six Essential Elements lexicon flags potential tensions with a strict "formation over information" stance when workforce/21st-century skills are foregrounded. The Saint Constantine materials foreground college preparation alongside formation, but the formation emphasis remains strong.

Why this rating - While there is clear college preparation via dual-credit and college-informed upper-level instruction, the overarching aim remains formation in virtue, truth, and the good within a liturgical Christian framework. The balance still reads as CLASSICAL in intent and method.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Seven liberal arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) is presented, with a detailed discussion of the Trivium and Quadrivium. - Great Books and the Great Conversation are highlighted (chronological study of great books in humanities; unabridged texts in upper school). - History is woven across the curriculum; foreign language, literature, philosophy, and Western/Christian intellectual heritage are foregrounded. The upper school materials emphasize primary texts and historical context. - The curriculum integrates faith with reason, philosophy, and literature (classical, Christian education).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts; grammar; logic; rhetoric; Great Books; great conversation; Latin and Greek; history; Western civilization; sacred tradition; catechesis; memorization/recitation as a classical memory technique. These terms appear in public materials. - Negative keywords present: the lexicon notes potential tensions with non-classical approaches (e.g., social studies framing, project-based learning as dominant). Public materials emphasize traditional Great Books and a classical canon rather than a modern social-studies framing.

Why this rating - The curriculum is clearly anchored in the liberal arts and Great Books within a classical, Christian frame, including both the Trivium and Quadrivium and a rigorous humanities emphasis. This aligns strongly with CLASSICAL criteria.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogy includes a mix of contemplative/restful aspects (Scholé-like rhythm; memory work; singing/chanting) in lower grades, and Socratic seminars, debates, and rhetoric training in upper grades. The upper school emphasizes Socratic discussion and rhetoric; lower grades emphasize memory and singing. - The schedule supports a disciplined but balanced approach, including a block schedule and a university-style sequence, with dedicated time for holidays/communal study. - Public materials describe a culture of discourse, challenging but welcoming to debate, with college professors involved in humanities instruction in upper levels (Socratic environment described in upper school).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic, seminar, dialectic, rhetoric, recitation, chanting, great conversation, scholé, contemplation, wonder, memory work, master-teacher model, public speaking, oratory, debate. The Saint Constantine site explicitly cites Socratic discussion and rhetoric training in upper school and memory/chanting in lower school. - Negative keywords present: The lexicon flags potential negatives like strictly project-based or experiential-only approaches; Saint Constantine emphasizes a mix, including traditional memory/chanting and Socratic discourse, not solely project-based learning. There is no strong public signal of a project-based-only pedagogy.

Why this rating - The pedagogical mix aligns with classical norms (Socratic discourse in higher grades; memory/chanting and contemplative elements in lower grades; emphasis on rhetoric and public speaking). This supports CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty are presented as core agents in the school's mission; examples include a robust faculty directory and the idea that teachers shepherd formation and learning, with many teaching across college and school levels (faculty with advanced degrees and living-curriculum orientation). The school highlights full-time faculty and advanced degrees, and the faculty is framed as mentors and guides in classical education. - The "Faculty" pages and public materials emphasize the teachers as central to the curriculum and community; a house-system and mentorship culture imply a close, relational faculty model.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; teacher as guide; collegial culture (as suggested by the public-facing materials and faculty pages). The public content emphasizes teacher expertise and a living, integrated curriculum. - Negative keywords present: the Six Elements lexicon notes potential negative signals (e.g., teacher-centric jargon without classical context) but public materials do not emphasize a purely credential-driven model; rather, they emphasize mentorship and living curriculum. No explicit negative signals dominate the public content.

Why this rating - The school presents a traditional, high-expectation faculty model with deeply integrated teaching and mentoring roles, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a partnership with families and emphasizes parental involvement and catechesis; the House System and School Life content indicate a lived sense of community and family integration. Public materials discuss parent collaboration, educational partnership, and opportunities to engage with the school. - The school highlights open campus, visits, and parent engagement in classical education (e.g., admissions visits, house life, and community events).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Partnership with Families; parent formation; family involvement; home-school connection; parent formation; living tradition in the family; parental engagement; open campus; events. These align with the Six Essentials' "Partnership with Families" and "Formation of Affections" themes. - Negative keywords present: The lexicon identifies potential signals such as "customer mindset" or minimal parent involvement; however, the Saint Constantine site emphasizes active parental partnership and engagement, with open visits and parent-focused programming. Public materials do not reflect Consumer/Customer signals.

Why this rating - The school actively frames parents as co-educators and partners in formation, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations.

Overall assessment: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle - Not applicable here, as no category is rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The Saint Constantine School already demonstrates a coherent classical orientation across all six categories, with evidence-backed alignment to the Six Essential Elements framework.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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